

Purpose :

This SOP establishes guidelines for the safe handling, inspection, and use of slings in lifting operations to prevent accidents, injuries, and equipment damage.

Scope:

Applies to all personnel involved in lifting operations using wire rope, chain, synthetic web, and round slings.

Types of Slings:

- Wire Rope Slings – Used for heavy loads, durable but prone to kinking.
- Chain Slings – Strong and heat-resistant, used in rugged environments.
- Web Slings – Lightweight, flexible, but sensitive to heat and sharp edges.

Pre-Use Inspection:

Before using any sling, inspect for:

- Wire Rope Slings: Kinks, broken wires, corrosion, deformation.
- Chain Slings: Bent, worn, or cracked links; stretched chains.
- Web Slings: Cuts, abrasions, burns, chemical damage, frayed stitching.
- Inspected monthly basis, If defects are found, tag the sling as "Do Not Use" and remove it from service, discarded and submit to the store.

Safe Usage Guidelines :

- Load Limits:

Always check the Working Load Limit (WLL) of the sling.

Angles & Hitching: Use proper hitching methods (vertical, basket, or choker hitch).

- Edge Protection:

Use padding on sharp edges to prevent damage.

Lifting Practices:

- Center the load properly.

Avoid shock loading or sudden jerks.

Keep hands and feet clear when tensioning slings.

Never drag slings on the ground.

- Tagging & Identification:

Ensure slings have proper tags with specifications and capacity details.

Storage & Maintenance :

Store slings in a dry, cool, and well-ventilated area.

Keep synthetic slings away from chemicals, UV exposure, and moisture.

Lubricate chain slings periodically to prevent corrosion.

PPE:

Ensure all technicians wear appropriate Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) including safety gloves, eye protection, high-visibility clothing, and insulated footwear.



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